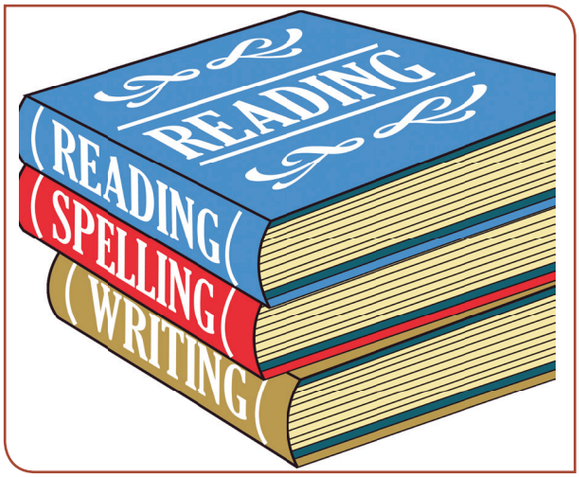
both students in colleges and those in class ten and twelve. A problem faced by any general-purpose 'English for the workplace', training course is that job related skills are often specific to context. Each work domain has its own special requirements with regard to communication: there may be particular kinds of reports or forms to be filled in, or perhaps interactions with people need to confirm to a corporate policy. For these reasons, workplace English training is best carried out by using materials taken from the workplace itself. In India, the main focus seems now to be on the idea of English for employability. But research has highlighted the equal importance of English in career progression.

What is the minimum proficiency for professional employment abroad?

6. Employability skills needed at schools and colleges include knowledge of English and soft skills. Most workers in the services sector – whether in offices, BPOs, hotels or shops – need to communicate in at least two different directions – to clients and within the chain of management in their own organizations. Here, workers may require –



a) both spoken and written language skills and the

b) ability to shift appropriately between informal and formal varieties of language.

c) English is seen as a means to move up in the social ladder and to have access to growth. It is seen not just as a useful skill, but as a symbol of a better life, a pathway out of poverty. English language is fast emerging as a powerful agent for change in India.

Glossary

vital (adj) : very important

negotiating (v) : consult others to reach an agreement

lingua franca (n) : a language adopted as a common one by people of different mother tongues

globalization (n) : operating on an international scale

proficiency (n) : high degree of skill

corporate (adj) : relating to a large company or group

progression (n) : the process of developing or moving gradually towards a more advanced state

emerging(v) : to come into view, to come out of a situation

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